LEADBEATER'S POSSUM

Leadbeater's possums are the **animal emblem of Victoria.**

They live in **Mountain Ash forests** around Healvesville, Marysville and Mt Baw Baw.

They are **nocturnal**. They hunt at night and sleep during the day.

They **feed** on tree sap and insects .

They are very small **marsupials.** They give birth to live young called **joeys** that they carry in pouches.

They live in **colonies of 6 - 12 possums** and protect a territory of 3 hectares. The same size as the Melbourne Cricket Ground (MCG)! Each colony has one mating pair that produce **two joeys every year.**

Leadbeater's Possums build **nests** in **tree hollows.** They line the hollows with strips of bark to make their nest cozy.

Each colony moves between **many nests** to find food and avoid predators.

It takes **80 years for Mountain Ash trees to develop hollows.** The best nesting hollows are in trees over 200 years old!

Look at how big the nests inside the hollows can be!

Leadbeater's possums rely on plants such as wattle trees and ferns in the **forest understory**. They use these plants for food and to move safely between bigger trees.